HEIRSTONE CONSULTING

RESORT ECONOMIES | KYRGYZSTAN

Fifty-two weekends

Issyk-Kul, Kyrgyzstan's summer lake, and what fills a resort's other months, measured against lake and mountain peers from Balaton to Shymbulak, with the Chatkal cluster beside Tashkent



SIX NUMBERS FROM THIS REPORT

49%

of Kyrgyzstan's 5.3 million recorded holidaymakers in 2025 stayed on Issyk-Kul: 894,000 in resorts and hotels and 1.7 million in guesthouses and homes

3.8%

of the country's hotel and restaurant revenue was booked in Issyk-Kul oblast in 2025, about US$12 per holidaymaker (Heirstone analysis)

10 days

of national census at the height of each summer are the official count of the lake's resorts and guesthouses

22.9x

nights in the busiest month against the quietest on Lake Balaton's beach shore in 2025; 3.6x on its thermal shore around Hévíz (Heirstone Season Benchmark)

8.3x

Asman's preliminary cost of about US$20bn, as reported by Economist.kg, against all other disclosed project costs around the lake combined (Heirstone analysis)

12m

tourist visits in 2024 to Bostanliq district beside Tashkent, according to the regional administration: the market a Chatkal cluster on the Kyrgyz side would share

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

Heirstone Consulting advises governments, developers, investors and lenders on destinations, resorts, hotels and specialised real estate across the Middle East, Africa and Central Asia. This report uses public sources current at publication in 2026: Kyrgyz and Uzbek official statistics, decrees and laws, central bank releases, project documents of international lenders, Eurostat and national statistics for the peer destinations, operator and developer disclosures, and press reports citing them.

Where we combine published figures into a new one, such as a ratio, a share or a value per unit, the result is labelled Heirstone analysis and the inputs are shown. Som values are converted at the National Bank of the Kyrgyz Republic rate of KGS 87.45 per US dollar at publication in 2026 unless stated, so the dollar value of an earlier som figure may differ from its value at the time.

READING THE EXHIBITS

Exhibits are numbered in page order. Each title states the finding, the line below it the measure, unit and period, and the source line the issuer and date. Plans, capacities and targets are attributed to the body that announced them and are not Heirstone forecasts.

SUMMARY

Issyk-Kul hosts half of Kyrgyzstan's holidaymakers in one short summer. Short breaks and health stays from Bishkek, Almaty and Tashkent can fill more of its year once access and utilities work beyond the peak.

We assembled Kyrgyzstan's tourism statistics, monthly data for 16 lake and mountain regions in Europe, season figures for resorts in Kazakhstan, Georgia and Egypt, the lake's project pipeline and the public record on a Kyrgyz–Uzbek cluster in Chatkal.

1 **The lake carries half the country's holidays and a sliver of its recorded spending.**

About 2.6 million of Kyrgyzstan's 5.3 million recorded holidaymakers stayed on Issyk-Kul in 2025, twice the 2019 count, yet the oblast booked 3.8% of national hotel and restaurant revenue, about US$12 a head. Two in three stayed in guesthouses and homes, for three days on average.

2 **Almost everything runs in one summer, and the state counts the lake in ten days.**

Every flight announced into Tamchy for 2025 and 2026 began in early or midsummer, and the Bishkek train ran for about 14 weeks in 2026. The Association of Pansionats said in 2020 that only 7 to 8 of about 150 pansionats open all year; the national guesthouse statistics are in practice a ten-day census at the height of summer.

3 **Peers show that anchors which ignore the weather flatten the year, and skiing adds a second peak.**

In the Heirstone Season Benchmark, Lake Balaton's beach shore swung 22.9 times between its busiest and quietest months in 2025, its thermal shore around Hévíz 3.6 times. Tirol's winter and summer peaks were level, but its late-autumn trough fell to a fifth of that and the region used 38% of its bed-nights. Shymbulak, beside Almaty, took 47% of its guests outside winter.

4 **A new city and a ski cluster lead the pipeline, and sewers set the pace on the shore.**

Asman's preliminary cost of about US$20bn, as reported by Economist.kg, is 8.3 times the disclosed cost of everything else around the lake, and the state's Ala-Too Resort plans 250 km of runs, 12.5 times Karakol. Cholpon-Ata, preferred by about 80% of the lake's visitors according to ADB, connects 43.1% of residents to sewers; its new plant was 10% built in late 2025.

5 **Chatkal could become a weekend valley for Tashkent once a road and a crossing serve it.**

Bostanliq district beside Tashkent recorded more than 12 million tourist visits in 2024, according to the regional administration; the Chatkal Resort project targets fewer than 500,000 tourists in 2040, about 4% of that. An ADB-funded plan for Chatkal District is due in 2027.

WHAT IT MEANS

The State Agency for Tourism Development should count the lake every month and keep flights and trains running from late spring to mid-autumn.

The regional administration should connect resorts to the new sewers before it licenses new beds.

Developers and operators should build winterised beds around a spa, meeting or ski anchor and plan for 25-40% annual bed use.

Investors and development lenders should fund the pipes first and base any ski finance on a demand study.

16

lake and mountain regions in the Heirstone Season Benchmark, with Central Asian, Georgian and Red Sea comparators

6

conditions in the Heirstone Four-Season Test, applied to four Kyrgyz resort areas

CHAPTER 1

01

Half the holidays, one summer

49%

of Kyrgyzstan's recorded holidaymakers stayed on Issyk-Kul in 2025 (Heirstone analysis of NSC counts)

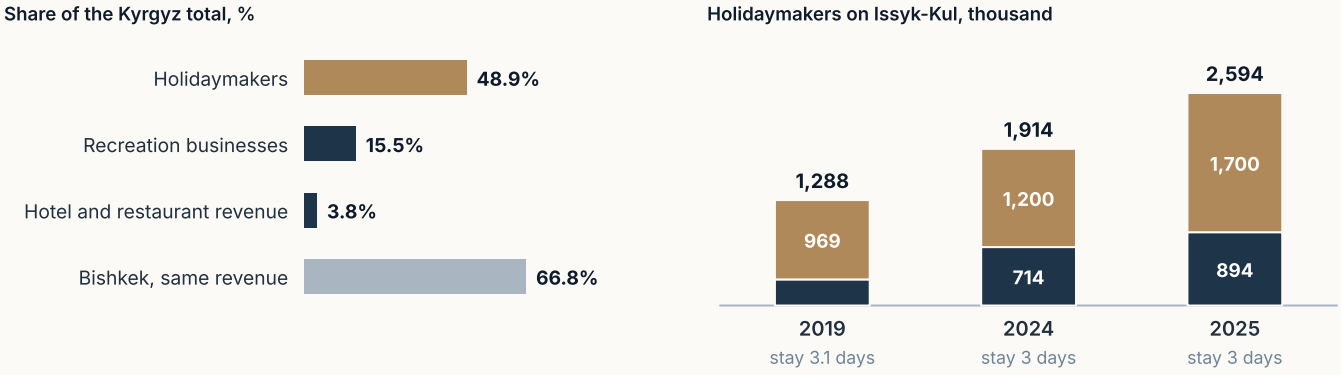
3.8%

of national hotel and restaurant revenue was booked in Issyk-Kul oblast in the same year

EXHIBIT 1

Issyk-Kul hosted 49% of Kyrgyzstan's recorded holidaymakers in 2025 and booked 3.8% of its hotel and restaurant revenue

Left: Issyk-Kul's share of national totals, %, 2025 (businesses at the start of 2026), with Bishkek for comparison; right: holidaymakers on Issyk-Kul, thousand, organised sector (navy) and guesthouses and homes in the resort zone (gold), with average guesthouse stay



Source: National Statistical Committee of the Kyrgyz Republic (NSC), Tourism in Kyrgyzstan 2015-2019 (2020), 2020-2024 (2025) and 2021-2025 (2026); NSC open data, hotel and restaurant services by territory. 2024 values are published as 'about' and 'more than'. Shares: **Heirstone analysis.**

Kyrgyzstan's National Statistical Committee counted 5.3 million holidaymakers in 2025, 1.5 times the year before. More than 894,000 stayed in Issyk-Kul's organised sector of resorts, pansionats and hotels, and 1.7 million in the guesthouses and homes of the lake's resort zone: together 49% of the national total, and twice the lake's 2019 count of 1.29 million.

Recorded spending is concentrated in the capital. Hotel and restaurant services in the oblast came to KGS 2,786m in 2025, about US$31.9m, while Bishkek booked 66.8% of the national total. Spread across the lake's holidaymakers, that is about KGS 1,070, or US$12, a head (Heirstone analysis). Two in three stay in guesthouses and homes, so the gap measures what the formal economy captures as much as what visitors spend.

2.0x

holidaymakers on Issyk-Kul in 2025 against 2019 (Heirstone analysis)

US$12

recorded hotel and restaurant revenue per holidaymaker on the lake in 2025 (Heirstone analysis)

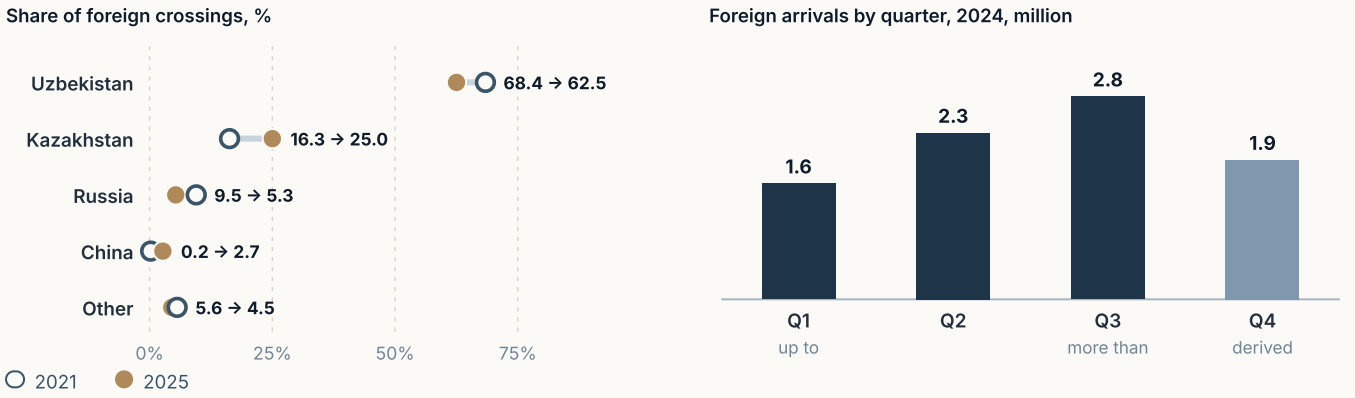
WHO COMES, AND WHEN

Kyrgyzstan receives visitors in every season; the lake receives them in summer

EXHIBIT 2

Kazakh citizens made a quarter of foreign border crossings in 2025, and national arrivals ran from about 1.6 million to more than 2.8 million a quarter in 2024

Left: foreign citizens' border crossings into Kyrgyzstan by citizenship, % of total, 2021 and 2025; right: foreign arrivals by quarter, 2024, million (fourth quarter derived)



Source: NSC, Tourism in Kyrgyzstan 2021-2025 (2026); Trend News Agency citing the Border Service (2025) for the quarters; fourth quarter = the 8.625m annual total less the first three: **Heirstone analysis.** Crossings count trips; one visitor may cross several times.

Foreign citizens crossed into Kyrgyzstan 10.5 million times in 2025. Many crossings are repeat trips by neighbours, so the figure overstates tourists. Uzbek citizens made 62.5% of them, about 6.6 million, and Kazakh citizens 25.0%, about 2.6 million, up from 16.3% in 2021 (Heirstone analysis of NSC shares). Kazakh citizens may enter on an identity card for 90 days in any 180, according to Tengrinews, and citizens of the six Gulf Cooperation Council states may stay 180 days in any 360 without a visa.

The national flow is far less seasonal than the lake. The Border Service counted up to 1.6 million arrivals in the first quarter of 2024 and more than 2.8 million in the third, a ratio of 1.75. Exports of tourist services, the spending of foreign visitors, were US$253.8m in the first quarter of 2023, 25.5% of that year's US$994.4m, and reached US$1.098bn in 2025, according to Economist.kg.

Few of these visitors reach the lake. NSC's sample survey of the lake's guesthouses found about 27,000 foreign citizens among 558,000 holidaymakers in 2025, 4.8%. The survey excludes hotels and resorts, and the deputy presidential envoy put foreign visitors to the oblast at more than 300,000 over the twelve months to late 2024. Both figures are far below the national crossings.

Air carries a small share of those who come. Issyk-Kul International Airport at Tamchy handled 40,300 passengers in 2024, 0.7% of the national total of 5.8 million, and Karakol airport 731. In summer 2025 about 16 weekly rotations were announced into Tamchy from Almaty, Tashkent and Novosibirsk (Heirstone analysis of airline announcements).

1.75

third-quarter arrivals against first-quarter arrivals in Kyrgyzstan, 2024 (Heirstone analysis)

0.7%

of Kyrgyzstan's air passengers used Tamchy in 2024: 40,300 of 5.8 million

2.6m

border crossings by Kazakh citizens in 2025 (Heirstone analysis)

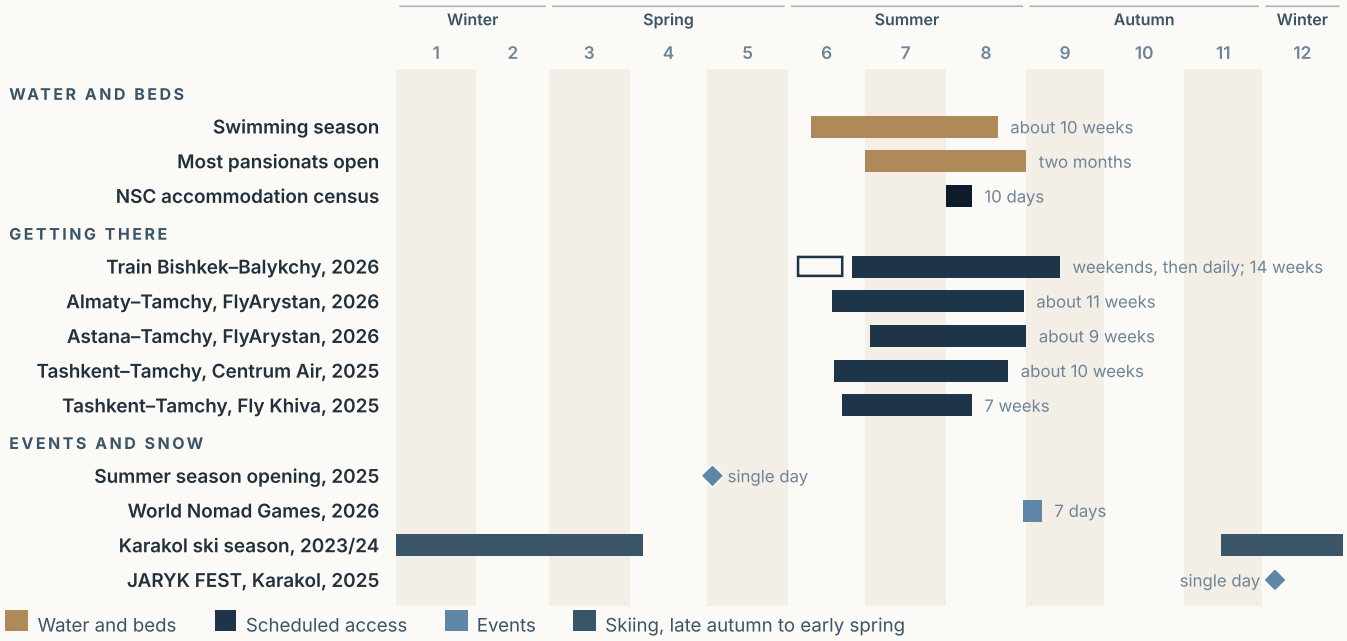
THE LAKE'S CALENDAR

Ten summer days set the lake's official picture

EXHIBIT 3

Almost everything that brings people to Issyk-Kul runs from early summer to early autumn

Operating periods as published for 2025 and 2026, by month (1 to 12) and season; labels give durations; diamonds mark single-day events



Source: Kaktus.media quoting the tour operators' association (2022); Tengrinews quoting the Association of Pansionats (2020); NSC (2026); 24.kg citing Kyrgyz Temir Zholu (2026); Economist.kg (2024; 2025; 2026); Aeroroutes (2025); Xinhua (2026). Routes announced without an end date (Silk Avia, S7, Asman Airlines) are not shown.

The National Statistical Committee measures the lake's accommodation once a year, in a census over the first ten days of the peak summer month. In 2025 it covered 181 collective establishments, 1,272 guesthouses inside resort grounds and 1,044 outside. The national count of guesthouses, 2,316, is the same number, and the national total of holidaymakers in the unorganised sector, 1.7 million, matches the lake's resort-zone figure. In practice Kyrgyzstan's guesthouse statistics are a high-summer survey of Issyk-Kul (Heirstone analysis).

No monthly series of nights, beds or occupancy for the lake was found. Without one, neither the state nor a lender can see whether a new hotel, a festival or a winter route has moved the low months.

The supply side offers only an indication. In 2020 the head of the Association of Pansionats told Tengrinews that 7 to 8 of about 150 pansionats on the lake work all year and the rest open only in high summer. The statement counts establishments, not beds or guests, so it does not measure visitor seasonality; no later figure has been published.

Year-round operators exist: Karven Four Seasons says it works all 365 days a year, with halls for up to 350, and Raduga at Chon-Sary-Oy sells itself as a year-round resort. Sanatorium services nationally rose 84.1% in the first quarter of 2026, to KGS 463.6m, according to Economist.kg.

10 days

at the height of summer: the window of the annual census of the lake's resorts and guesthouses

7-8

of about 150 pansionats on the lake open all year, according to the Association of Pansionats (2020)

+84%

growth in sanatorium services in the first quarter of 2026, nationally



CHAPTER 2

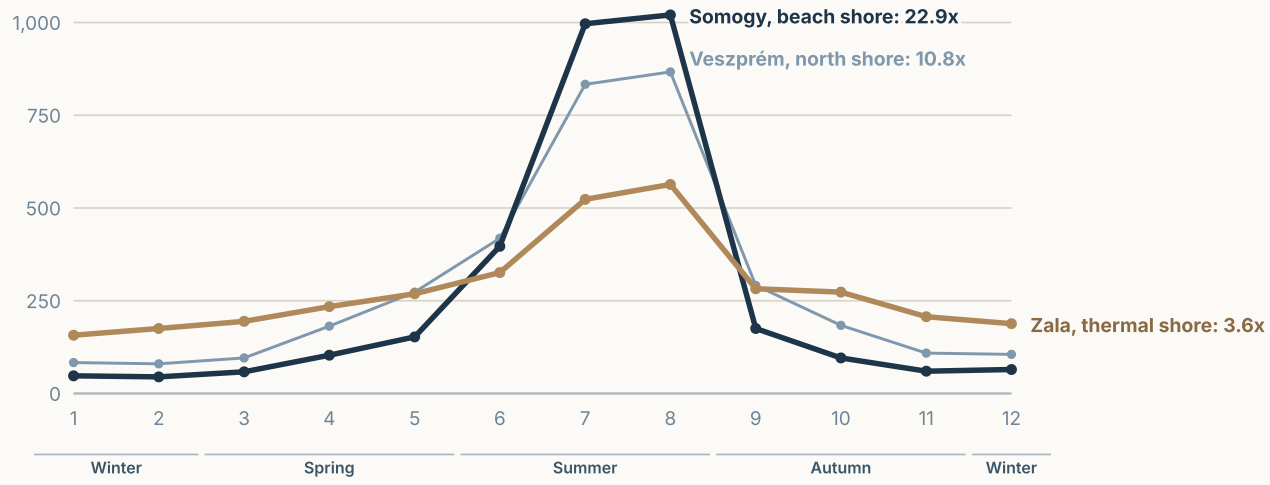
02 How lakes and mountains fill the year

Issyk-Kul publishes no monthly series, so we built one from its peers. The Heirstone Season Benchmark compares monthly nights in 16 lake and mountain regions of Europe in 2025, and adds season figures for resorts in Austria, Kazakhstan, Georgia and Egypt.

EXHIBIT 4

On Lake Balaton the beach shore swung 22.9 times between its busiest and quietest months in 2025; the thermal shore around Hévíz swung 3.6 times

Nights in commercial and private accommodation by month (1 to 12), 2025, thousand: Somogy (south-shore beach resorts), Veszprém (north shore) and Zala (Hévíz thermal lake and spa towns); ratios are busiest month to quietest



Source: Hungarian Central Statistical Office (KSH), STADAT 27.2.2.1, monthly tourism nights by county (accessed 2026). Commercial and private accommodation summed: **Heirstone analysis.** On commercial accommodation alone the ratios are 14.6 (Somogy), 9.2 (Veszprém) and 2.65 (Zala).

Somogy and Zala share a lake, a climate and a capital-city catchment. Somogy, the south shore of Siófok and Balatonlelle, took 62.7% of its 2025 nights in the two high-summer months, more than Croatia's 55%, the highest national share in the EU. Zala took 32.0%, and its quietest winter month reached 28% of its summer peak.

The shores differ in what they sell in winter. Zala includes Hévíz, a thermal lake whose water does not fall below 22°C in winter, according to the spa that runs it, and the spa towns of Zalakaros and Keszthely. Hévíz recorded 854,380 commercial guest nights in 2023, second among Hungarian settlements after Budapest, according to Economx.

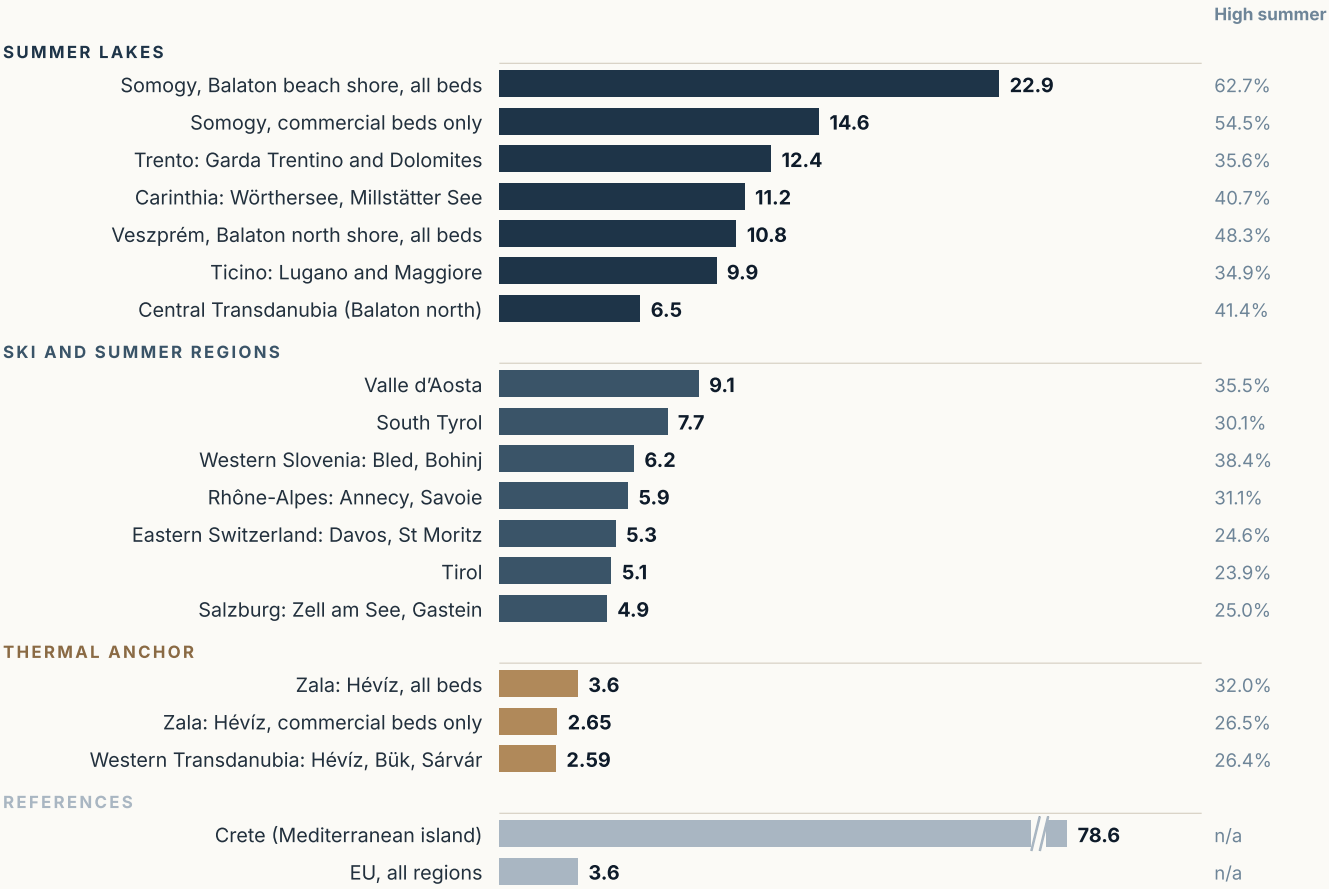
THE HEIRSTONE SEASON BENCHMARK

Most summer lake regions swing ten to 23 times between their busiest and quietest months; ski regions swing five to nine times

EXHIBIT 5

Heirstone Season Ratio 2025: Balaton's beach shore 22.9, Tirol 5.1, Hévíz's thermal shore 3.6

Nights in the busiest month divided by nights in the quietest month, 2025, with the share of annual nights in months 7 and 8 (high summer)



Source: Eurostat, tour_occ_nin2m, monthly nights at tourist accommodation by NUTS 2 region, all residents (updated 2026); KSH STADAT 27.2.2.1 (counties); Eurostat Statistics Explained (EU) and tour_occ_nin2m (Crete, 2025). **Heirstone Season Benchmark; Heirstone analysis.** NUTS 2 regions include cities and inland areas.

Where the lake is the main product the swing is wide: Carinthia's lake region swung 11.2 times in 2025 and Ticino's lakes 9.9 times, though both stay far below Crete's 78.6. In the ski regions Tirol's winter and summer peaks were almost level, at 5.3 million and 5.2 million nights, but its late-autumn trough fell to 1.0 million.

The flattest profiles belong to places with a draw that does not depend on the season. Western Transdanubia, home to the Hévíz, Bük and Sárvár spas, swung 2.6 times and kept eight months at half its peak or more, as many as Tirol. Issyk-Kul publishes no monthly nights and cannot be placed in the benchmark; a swimming season of about ten weeks and the summer-only opening of most pansionats point to the profile of a summer lake.

3.6

EU-wide ratio of nights in the busiest month to the quietest in 2025, the same as Hévíz's shore

8

months at half the peak or more in Western Transdanubia and in Tirol, against 2 on Balaton's beach shore (Heirstone analysis)

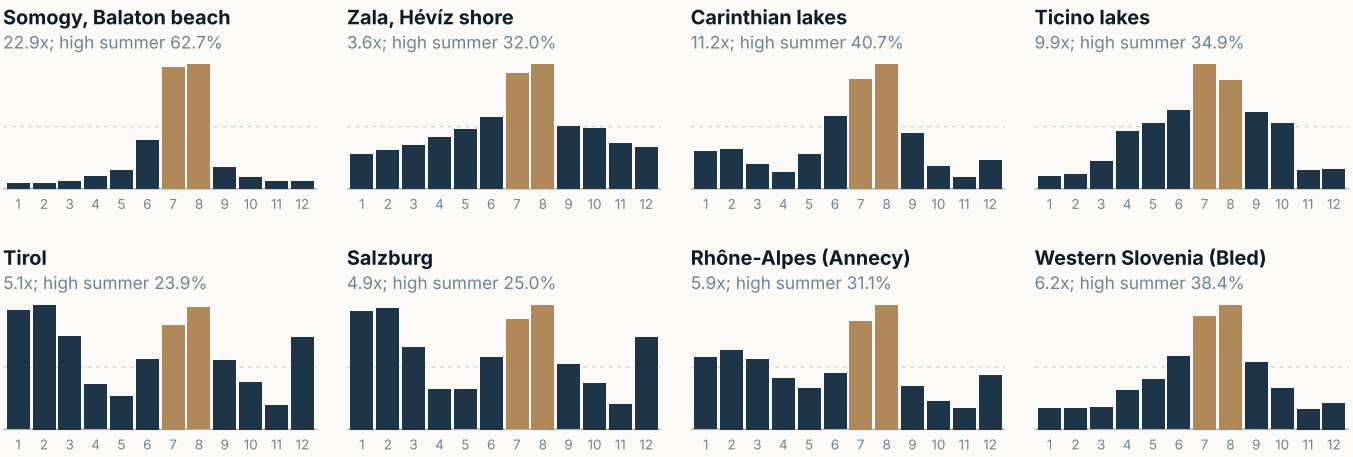
SHAPES AND BEDS

Two peaks still leave four slack months, and even Tirol sells little more than a third of its bed-nights

EXHIBIT 6

Summer lakes have one long winter trough; ski regions trade it for two shallower ones, in spring and late autumn

Monthly nights indexed to the busiest month, 2025, months 1 to 12; months 7 and 8 (high summer) in gold; the dashed line marks half the peak

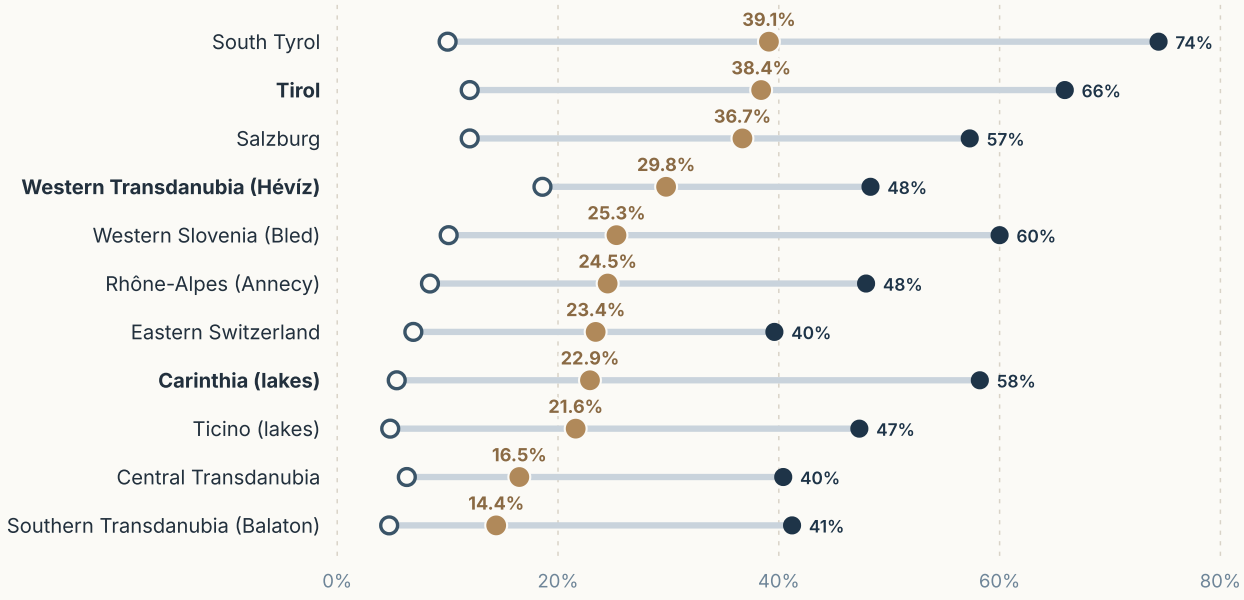


Source: Eurostat, tour_occ_nin2m (updated 2026); KSH STADAT 27.2.2.1 (Somogy and Zala, commercial and private accommodation). **Heirstone analysis.**

EXHIBIT 7

The best-performing Alpine regions used 38-39% of their bed-places across 2025; Balaton's three regions 14-30%

Nights divided by bed-places times days, 2025, %: whole year (gold, labelled), and the quietest (ring) and busiest (navy) months by nights



Source: Eurostat, tour_cap_nuts2 (bed-places) and tour_occ_nin2m (nights), 2025. **Heirstone analysis.** The annual bed stock includes establishments closed off-season, so these rates sit below the room occupancy of open hotels. Trento and Valle d'Aosta omitted: their 2025 bed counts show a break in series.

For anyone modelling a resort hotel on Issyk-Kul, these are the reference points. South Tyrol and Tirol, with two full seasons, sold about 39% of their bed-nights in 2025; Carinthia's lakes 23% and the Balaton south-shore region 14%.

A business plan that assumes 60-70% annual use across a lake's whole stock would be out of line with every peer. Single hotels do better when open all year: Lake Annecy's hotels averaged 68% occupancy in 2022, 57% in winter.

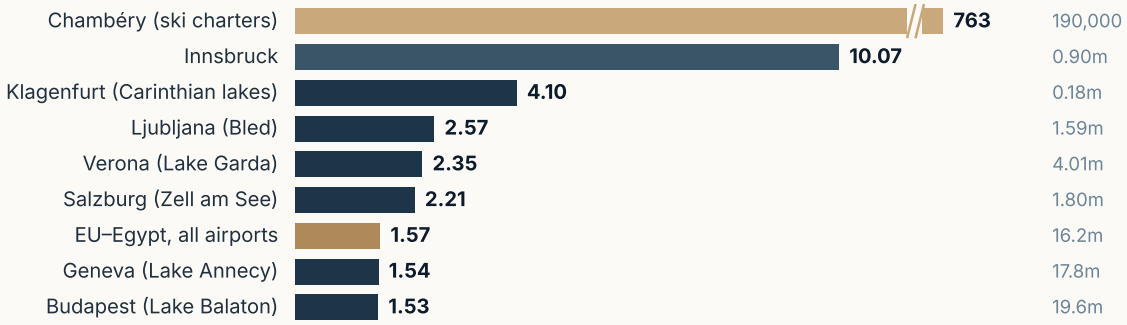
ACCESS AND MARKETS

City gateways keep flying through the low months, and Gulf guests come in summer

EXHIBIT 8

Resort airports magnify the season: Innsbruck's busiest month was ten times its quietest in 2025, Geneva's and Budapest's about one and a half times

Passengers in the busiest month divided by passengers in the quietest month, 2025 (Chambéry bar cut), with 2025 annual passengers; the EU–Egypt series covers all Egyptian airports

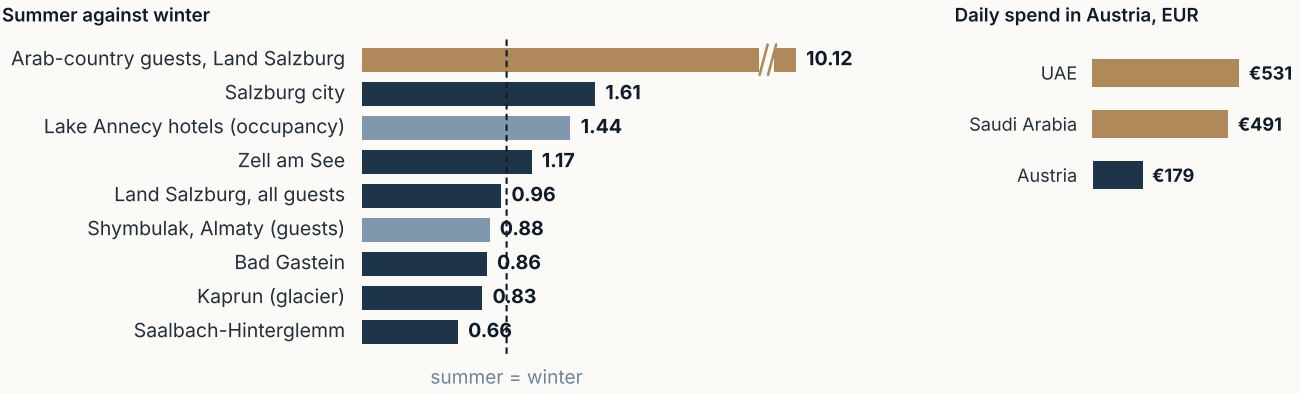


Source: Eurostat, avia_paoa (airports) and avia_paexcc (EU27–Egypt), monthly passengers carried (extracted 2026). **Heirstone analysis.** Tamchy handled 40,300 passengers in 2024 (Airports of Kyrgyzstan via Economist.kg); no monthly series is published.

EXHIBIT 9

Guests from Arab countries spent ten nights in Salzburg's summer for every night in its winter, and Gulf visitors spend about three times as much a day as Austrians

Left: nights in the summer half-year 2025 divided by nights in the winter half-year 2024/25, as defined by Austrian statistics; Shymbulak guests and Lake Annecy hotel occupancy on their own bases (Arab-country bar cut); right: daily spending excluding travel, EUR



Source: Land Salzburg statistics, Tourismus Sommersaison 2025 and Wintersaison 2025; Salzburg24 citing Österreich Werbung (2026); 24.kz citing Kazakhstan's Ministry of Tourism and Sports (2025); Savoie Mont Blanc Tourisme, Lac d'Annecy (2023). **Heirstone analysis.**

Innsbruck carried 72% of its 2025 passengers in its four winter months; Chambéry handled fewer than 500 a month for the seven months from late spring to late autumn. Every route announced into Tamchy for 2025 and 2026 started in early or midsummer, and those with published end dates had stopped by the end of summer.

Guests from Arab countries spent 644,000 nights in Land Salzburg in summer 2025 and 63,649 in winter 2024/25, and made up 25.7% of summer nights around Zell am See and Kaprun, according to Salzburg24. For a summer lake, Gulf demand fits the season it already has and can lengthen it.

72%

of Innsbruck's 2025 passengers flew in its four winter months (Heirstone analysis)

10.1x

summer against winter nights, Arab-country guests in Salzburg

THE HEIRSTONE FOUR-SEASON TEST

Six conditions separate the lakes and mountains that work all year from those that close after summer

Each condition comes from a measured difference in the benchmark: two shores of one lake, two kinds of airport, ski regions against summer lakes. Chapter 7 applies the test to four resort areas in Kyrgyzstan.

1

A draw that ignores the weather

Thermal water, health, indoor leisure or winter sun that brings guests in the low months.

2.65x

Zala's swing on commercial beds, against 14.6x on Balaton's beach shore

2

A market within weekend reach

A city of a million or more, or a base of residents and businesses, within about three hours.

47%

of Shymbulak's 1.5 million guests came outside winter; the resort is 25 km from Almaty

3

Access that runs all year

Flights and trains that keep operating in the low months, ideally through a gateway that also serves a city.

1.5x

swing at Geneva and Budapest airports, against 10.1x at Innsbruck

4

A second season on snow

Lifts, runs and winter beds that create a second peak, while accepting that spring and late autumn stay quiet.

1.02

Tirol's winter-peak nights against its summer peak; its late-autumn trough was a fifth of the winter peak

5

A calendar for the shoulder months

Recurring events, fairs and meetings placed in spring and autumn, and measured.

300+

events a year at Garda Trentino; its Bike Festival brought 23.2% of the destination company's revenue

6

Pipes and data for the real peak

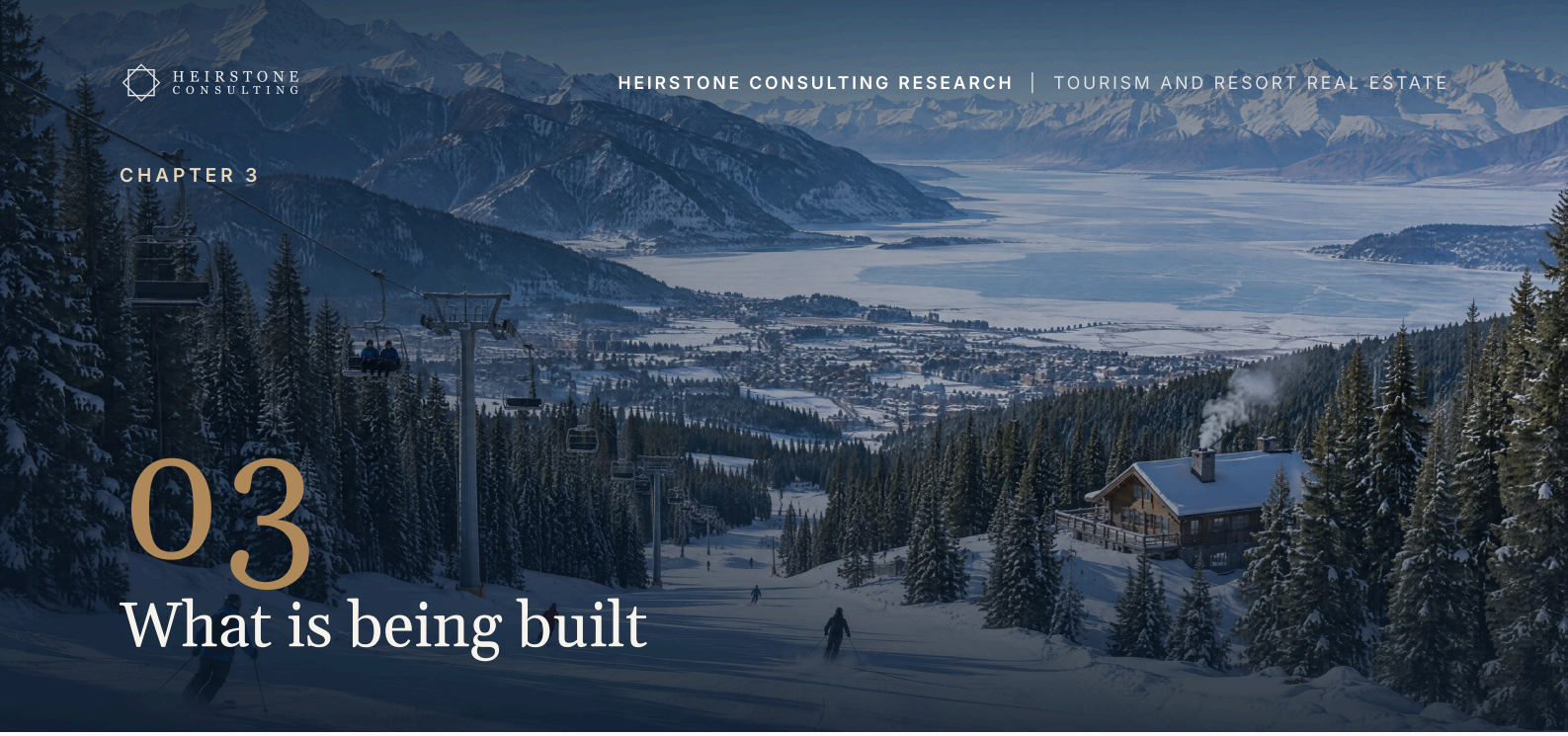
Water and wastewater sized for the busiest month, and nights counted every month in all types of accommodation.

53%

of Somogy's high-summer nights were in private accommodation; about 35% of Burabay's visitors used registered beds

The test is a checklist for sequencing public and private investment. It does not predict nights or occupancy, and it scores only what the public record shows: a condition is met, partly met or under way, not met, or not verified.

Snow is listed fourth because in the Alps it produces a second peak and leaves spring and late autumn quiet; the first three conditions are the ones that raise the floor of the year.



CHAPTER 3

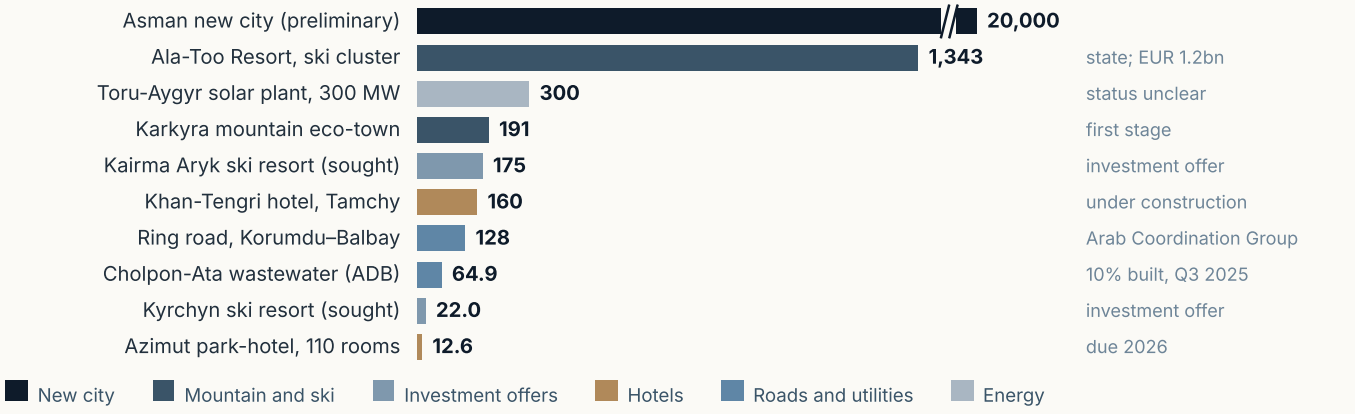
03 What is being built

The state has two large projects on the lake, a new city near Balykchy and a ski cluster east of Karakol. International hotel brands are building on the north shore between the airport and Cholpon-Ata.

EXHIBIT 10

Asman's preliminary cost of about US$20bn, as reported in 2025, is 8.3 times the disclosed cost of every other project around the lake combined

Disclosed or sought cost of named projects in the Issyk-Kul region, US$m (Asman bar cut); costs are not disclosed for Marriott, Mövenpick, Baku Resort & Spa, Elizaveta Resort or Tamchy Resort



Source: Economist.kg (2025, Asman; 2026, Ala-Too Resort); Kaktus.media (2025: Karkyra, Khan-Tengri, Azimut, solar plant); National Investment Agency project cards issykkul-19 and issykkul-25 (2026); OPEC Fund; ADB 55250-001. EUR converted at US$1.1193 (NBKR cross rate, 2026). Sum and multiple: **Heirstone analysis.** The Asman, Karkyra, Khan-Tengri, Azimut and solar costs each rest on a single press report.

Excluding Asman, the projects with a published cost add up to about US$2.4bn, of which Ala-Too Resort is more than half. The brand projects publish room counts and keep their budgets undisclosed: Marriott, Baku Resort & Spa and Azimut account for about 350 branded rooms and 33 villas between them, all on the north shore (Heirstone analysis).

A presidential decree of 2024 set out the concept of Asman as a pilot ecologically clean city and made its construction a strategic task of the Cabinet. Earlier that year the state construction agency reported 3,143 ha of land converted for the project and a workers' dormitory built. By 2025 an agreement with CITIC Merchant and Module House had ended, according to Kaktus.media; no later investor has been announced.

US$2.4bn

disclosed cost of named projects around the lake excluding Asman (Heirstone analysis)

350

branded rooms disclosed by three hotels on the north shore, plus 33 villas

WHERE THE PROJECTS ARE

The new beds cluster on 40 km of north shore between the airport and Bosteri; the state's two large projects sit at either end of the lake

EXHIBIT 11

Hotel brands and the airport hotel zone line the north shore; Asman lies at the lake's western end and Ala-Too Resort beyond its eastern end

Towns, airports and named projects around Issyk-Kul, 2026; gold circles are resort, hotel and city projects, blue squares roads, utilities and energy



1 Asman new city, 4,015 ha (approximate site)
2 Kosh-Kol golf resort, 104 ha
3 Tamchy: 90 ha hotel zone, Khan-Tengri, Elizaveta and Tamchy Resort
4 Baku Resort & Spa, Kara-Oi, opened 2026
5 Issyk Kul Marriott Resort and Mövenpick (Ak Keme), Cholpon-Ata
6 Azimut park-hotel, Baktuu-Dolonotu
7 Ala-Too Resort, Jyrgalan, 3,916 ha
8 Karkyra eco-town (approximate)
9 Karakol ski base, about 7 km from Karakol (approximate)
A Cholpon-Ata treatment plant and sewers (ADB)
B Ring road, Korumdu–Balbay, 80.5 km (schematic)
C Toru-Aygyr solar plant, 300 MW
D Kok-Moynok wind farm (approximate)

Source: Coordinates: GeoNames gazetteer (2026); Asman (midpoint of Toru-Aygyr and Chyrpykty), Karkyra, the Karakol ski base and Kok-Moynok are approximate, and hotel projects are placed at their settlement. Lake area and altitude: ILEC World Lake Database. Bishkek–Balykchy: Balykchy Mayor's Office (2019). Natural Earth (lakes, boundaries). Straight-line distance: **Heirstone analysis.**

Almaty lies 68 km from Cholpon-Ata in a straight line, across the mountains, but 450-480 km by road through Bishkek, according to Tengrinews. An ADB-supported tourism plan for the Almaty–Bishkek corridor notes that a road through Uzynagash and Kemin would cut the trip to about 260 km; it is at feasibility stage.

The train from Bishkek reaches Balykchy, on the western tip, in 4 hours 31 minutes, short of the north-shore resorts. Tamchy airport has a 3,800 m runway; it lies 35-40 minutes from Cholpon-Ata, according to Tengrinews, and a terminal for 450 passengers an hour was expected around mid-2026.

68 km

Almaty to Cholpon-Ata in a straight line, against 450-480 km by road (Heirstone analysis)

4h31

by summer train from Bishkek to Balykchy, for KGS 150-180

THE PIPELINE

A five-star resort opened in 2026 and three more international brands are building; the city at the western end is at an early stage

EXHIBIT 12

Most named hotel and residential projects are on the north shore and under construction; the ski cluster's utilities are largely built and its first zone is due by the end of 2026

Named projects in the Issyk-Kul region with sponsor, scale, cost and status as reported at the date shown; n/d not disclosed

PROJECT AND LOCATION	SPONSOR	SCALE	US$M	STATUS AS REPORTED	STAGE
NEW CITY					
Asman eco-city Toru-Aygyr to Chyrpykty	State directorate; earlier partners Promise Land (Korea), CITIC Merchant and Module House	4,015 ha; 500,000-700,000 residents (design)	20,000 (prelim.)	Decreed 2024; an investor agreement ended by 2025	PLANNED
MOUNTAIN AND SKI					
Ala-Too Resort Jyrgalan, Ak-Bulak, Boz-Uchuk	State enterprise	3,916 ha; 250 km of runs planned	1,343	Water intake 95%, networks 50% (2026); first zone due by end-2026	UNDER WAY
Karakol ski base 7 km from Karakol	Existing base	4 lifts; 20 km of runs	n/d	About 200,000 visits, winter 2023/24	OPEN
Karkyra eco-town Tyup district	Ekogorod Karkyra	Recreation zone for up to 5,000	191	First stage under way (2024)	UNDER WAY
Kairma Aryk Site not published	Kerege-Tash Travel	185 ha; 5,000-6,500 guests at once	175 sought	Investment offer (2026)	OFFER
Kyrchyn Ski Resort 40 km from Cholpon-Ata	MEKA Profi	2 hotels for 300; 25 cottages; 6.7 km of cable cars	22 sought	Investment offer (2026)	OFFER
HOTELS AND RESIDENCES					
Baku Resort & Spa Kara-Oi	Kyrgyz-Azerbaijani (intergovernmental)	120+ rooms; 17 ha incl. 1 ha public beach	n/d	Opened 2026, according to WE Project	OPEN
Issyk Kul Marriott Resort Cholpon-Ata	RAMS Global (Turkish, per TÜRKSAM); Marriott contract 30+ years	120 rooms and suites; 33 villas; 7.7 ha	n/d	3 of 5 floors built (2026); opening 2028	UNDER WAY
Ak Keme / Mövenpick Cholpon-Ata, first line	ExpoStroy; Mövenpick (Accor)	Hotel and branded flats; about 10 ha + 3 ha beach	n/d	Three-year build from 2025	UNDER WAY
Azimut park-hotel Baktuu-Dolonotu	Russian-Kyrgyz Development Fund (US$9.3m)	110 rooms	12.6	Completion expected mid-2026	UNDER WAY
Airport hotel zone Tamchy	State plots	Nine 10 ha plots for five-star hotels	n/d	One hotel under construction, the President said (2025)	UNDER WAY
Khan-Tengri hotel Tamchy	Not named	Five-star hotel	160	Capsule laid 2024	UNDER WAY
Elizaveta Resort Tamchy	Elizaveta	Hotel, flats, villas; 2,000 m² aquathermal centre; marina	n/d	Under construction (2026)	UNDER WAY
Tamchy Resort Tamchy	Not named	720 flats, 132 cottages and villas; 24.2 ha	n/d	Completion planned Q4 2027	UNDER WAY
Kosh-Kol golf resort Kosh-Kol	Not named	104 ha; 68.5 ha golf; 1,500+ flats	n/d	Rezoned 2024; no progress reported since	PLANNED
ACCESS, WATER AND POWER					
Cholpon-Ata wastewater (ADB) Cholpon-Ata	State agency; ADB grant and loan	14,200 m³/day plant; 150+ km of sewers; 11 km promenade	64.9	10% built (Q3 2025); closing 2030	UNDER WAY
Ring road upgrade Korumdu–Balbay	Ministry of Transport; Arab Coordination Group	80.5 km, four lanes, cycle lane	128	Procurement notice issued (2021)	UNDER WAY
Tamchy airport terminal Tamchy	Not stated	18,500 m²; 450 passengers an hour	n/d	Expected about mid-2026	UNDER WAY
Toru-Aygyr solar plant Toru-Aygyr	Bishkek Solar; Eurasian Development Bank	300 MW on 62 ha	300	No progress reported by mid-2025	PLANNED

Source: Kaktus.media (2025; 2026); Economist.kg (2025; 2026); WE Project (2026); TÜRKSAM (2026); 24.kg (2024); National Investment Agency (2026); ADB 55250-001; Ministry of Transport procurement notice (2021); Karakol ski base. Single press reports: Kaktus.media (Asman agreement, Karkyra, Ak Keme, Azimut, airport zone, Khan-Tengri, Kosh-Kol, solar plant); WE Project (Baku Resort & Spa opening, Elizaveta, Tamchy Resort).

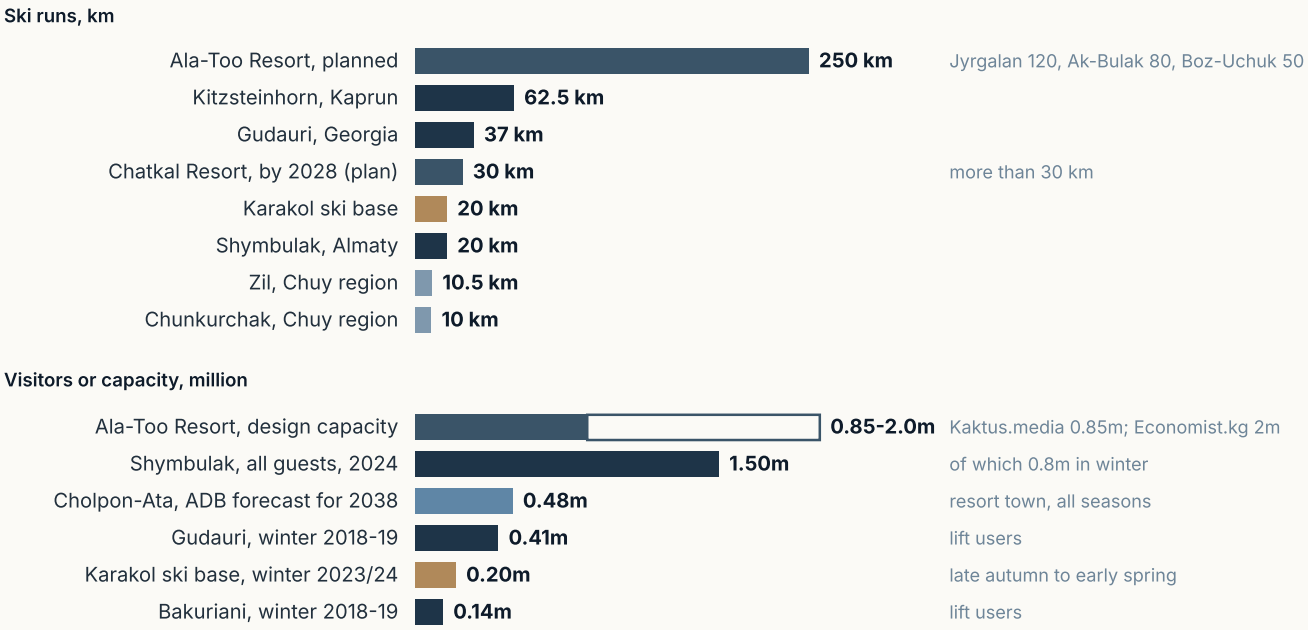
THE SECOND SEASON

Ala-Too Resort is planned at 12.5 times Karakol's runs, and its capacity has been reported at 850,000 and at 2 million visitors a year

EXHIBIT 13

Ala-Too Resort plans 250 km of runs, almost seven times Gudauri's; Karakol drew about 200,000 visits on 20 km in 2023/24

Top: km of ski runs, existing and planned; bottom: visitors in the latest published season or year, and design capacity, million



Source: Kaktus.media (2025); Economist.kg (2024; 2025); Skiresort.com (Karakol, Shymbulak, Zil, Chunkurchak); Georgian National Tourism Administration (Gudauri, 2024); Gletscherbahnen Kaprun; Chatkal Resort presentation (carecprogram.org); 24.kz (2025); Investor.ge (2020); ADB 55250-001. Measures differ: lift users, guests and design capacity.

The Cabinet gave the state enterprise Ala-Too Resort 3,916 ha in Ak-Suu district in 2024. The plan is for about 250 km of runs, a season of up to seven months using snow retention, 4,000 parking spaces and about 5,000 jobs. The Ministry of Construction puts the cost at EUR 1.2bn, about EUR 4.8m per km of run (Heirstone analysis). Austria's MRM is to equip the rental and service centres by the end of 2026, and 14 of 49 state plots in lower Jyrgalan had found buyers by 2025, according to Economist.kg.

Kaktus.media reported a capacity of up to 850,000 tourists a year in 2025, and Economist.kg up to 2 million at the launch later that year; no public demand study for either figure was found. Even the lower figure is above ADB's forecast of 480,000 visitors in 2038 for Cholpon-Ata, the lake's main resort, and four times Karakol's winter. The Alpine data in chapter 2 suggest a cluster this size would add a winter peak and leave spring and late autumn to other products. Almaty, about 380 km by road from the lake's eastern shore according to Tengrinews, will host the 2029 Asian Winter Games under a contract signed in 2026.

12.5x

Ala-Too Resort's planned runs against Karakol's 20 km (Heirstone analysis)

EUR 4.8m

planned cost per km of run at Ala-Too Resort (Heirstone analysis)

US$15-18

adult day pass at Karakol in winter 2024/25, KGS 1,300-1,600

CHAPTER 4

04 The hundred-metre line

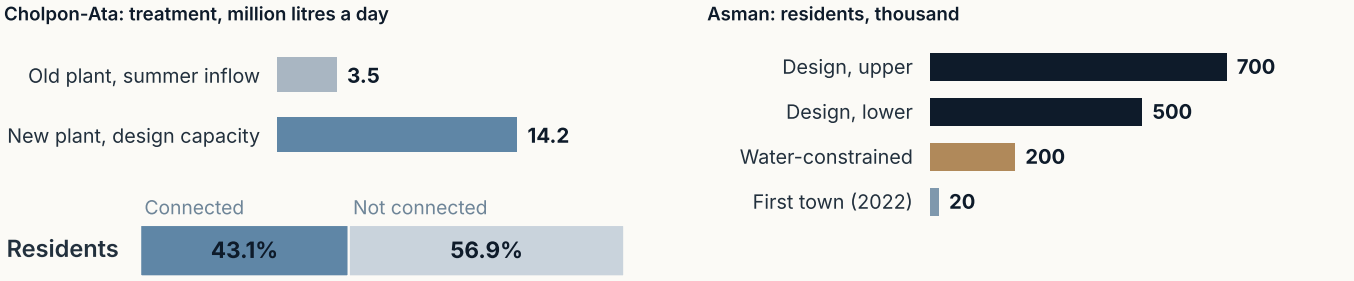
Two sets of limits decide what can be built around the lake and where: the capacity of its water and sewer systems, and the rules for the shore and for foreign tenure.

This chapter sets out both, and what the asking prices of flats and land show about demand for resort property.

EXHIBIT 14

Cholpon-Ata's new plant is designed for four times the old plant's summer inflow; Asman's design population is up to 3.5 times the level its directorate said water could support in 2022

Left: Cholpon-Ata wastewater, million litres a day, and residents connected to sewers, %; right: Asman population, design and the 2022 water-constrained level, thousand



Source: ADB, project 55250-001 (approved 2024; progress Q3 2025); Times of Central Asia citing the State Agency of Architecture and Construction (2024); Kaktus.media (2022); Economist.kg (2025). 14,200 m³ a day = 14.2 million litres. **Heirstone analysis.**

ADB states that about 80% of the lake's visitors prefer Cholpon-Ata, where 43.1% of residents are connected to sewers and the network misses almost a third of tourism facilities. Its 40-year-old plant receives up to 3.5 million litres a day in summer. ADB approved a US$31m grant and a US$25m concessional loan in 2024, with US$8.9m from the government, for a 14,200 m³ a day plant, 18 pumping stations, more than 150 km of sewers, an 11 km promenade and three parks. Works were 10% complete in the third quarter of 2025.

A 2022 presidential decree barred resorts without water, sewers and treatment from operating from 2023. Power is the next limit: the 2004 lake law requires resorts not to burden local supply, and an EBRD loan approved in 2025 is upgrading substations for the Kara-Oi resort zone, according to Kaktus.media.

Asman's water was assessed early. In 2022 its directorate said drinking water might suffice for about 200,000 people, and the head of the Cabinet proposed starting with a town of about 20,000. The design remains 500,000-700,000 on 4,015 ha, or 125-174 residents a hectare, against 50 at the 2022 water level (Heirstone analysis).

43.1%
of Cholpon-Ata residents connected to the sewer network (ADB)

4.1x
the new plant's design capacity against the old plant's summer inflow (Heirstone analysis)

US$4,570
per m³ of daily treatment capacity, all-in ADB package (Heirstone analysis)

THE RULES FOR THE SHORE

Foreigners may own resort buildings and lease the land, and the first 100 metres of shore stay closed to capital construction

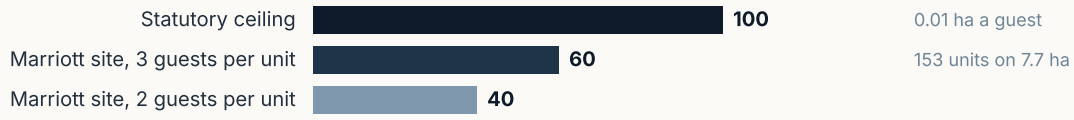
EXHIBIT 15

Foreign tenure moved from 49-year use to ownership of resort buildings in 2024, while the 100 m construction ban holds and the land norm caps density at 100 guests a hectare

Top: laws, resolutions and decrees governing construction, land and tenure on Issyk-Kul, as published to 2026; bottom: guests per hectare on one hotel site if the resort land norm applies, against the ceiling

INSTRUMENT	DATE	RULE	STATUS
Law No. 115 on the Issyk-Kul ecological-economic system, Art. 19	2004	No capital construction within 100 m of the lake; no non-recreation construction within 500 m	In force; a 2026 bill would exempt houses on plots allocated before the 2004 law (1,145 plots in Balykchy)
Law No. 115, Art. 19	2004	Land per guest: 0.01 ha at resorts, 0.02 ha at sanatoria, 0.005 ha elsewhere; at least 50% greenery	In force
Law No. 115, Art. 17 and 23	2004	No wastewater discharge into the lake or its rivers; resorts must not burden local power supply	In force
Government Resolution No. 547	2004	State land in the resort zone sold at auction; foreign winners receive term use, capped at 50 years	In force
Amendment to Law No. 115	2024	Foreign persons may own recreation buildings such as pansionats and rest homes; land only in term use	In force (replaced 49-year use only)
Presidential decree on preserving Lake Issyk-Kul	2022	Resorts without water, sewers and treatment may not operate from 2023	Issued
Presidential decree on access to beaches	2022	Access to beach zones may not be restricted	In force
Cabinet Resolution No. 224	2025	Piers, electric steam baths, networks, catering and toilets with treatment allowed within 100 m; Cabinet may grant exceptions	In force
Draft law	2026	Piers, boathouses and catering closer than 100 m in some cases; some facilities in the 100-500 m zone by Cabinet decision	Public discussion
National Investment Agency register	current	PPP agreements of up to 49 years; customs exemptions; special investment regime 'SFIT Tamchy' (terms not published)	In force

Guests per hectare under the resort land norm



Source: Law No. 115 of 2004 and Resolution No. 547 of 2004 (FAOLEX texts; later amendments may change wording); Economist.kg (2024; 2025; 2026); 24.kg (2022); National Investment Agency register. Densities assume the norm applies to the site: **Heirstone analysis.**

Read together, the rules move value back from the water. Capital buildings must stand beyond 100 m, while piers, steam baths, catering and promenades may now come closer; a lakefront asset is a building in the 100-500 m band with rights to a pier or beach that stays open to the public.

The structure is close to the leasehold models Gulf investors know: the building is owned, the land held for a term of up to 50 years at auction or 49 under a PPP. A 30-year management contract such as Marriott's fits within it. The land norm favours low-density, upscale formats over flats.

100 m

from the water's edge: no capital construction since 2004

50 years

maximum term of state land use, including lease, in the resort zone

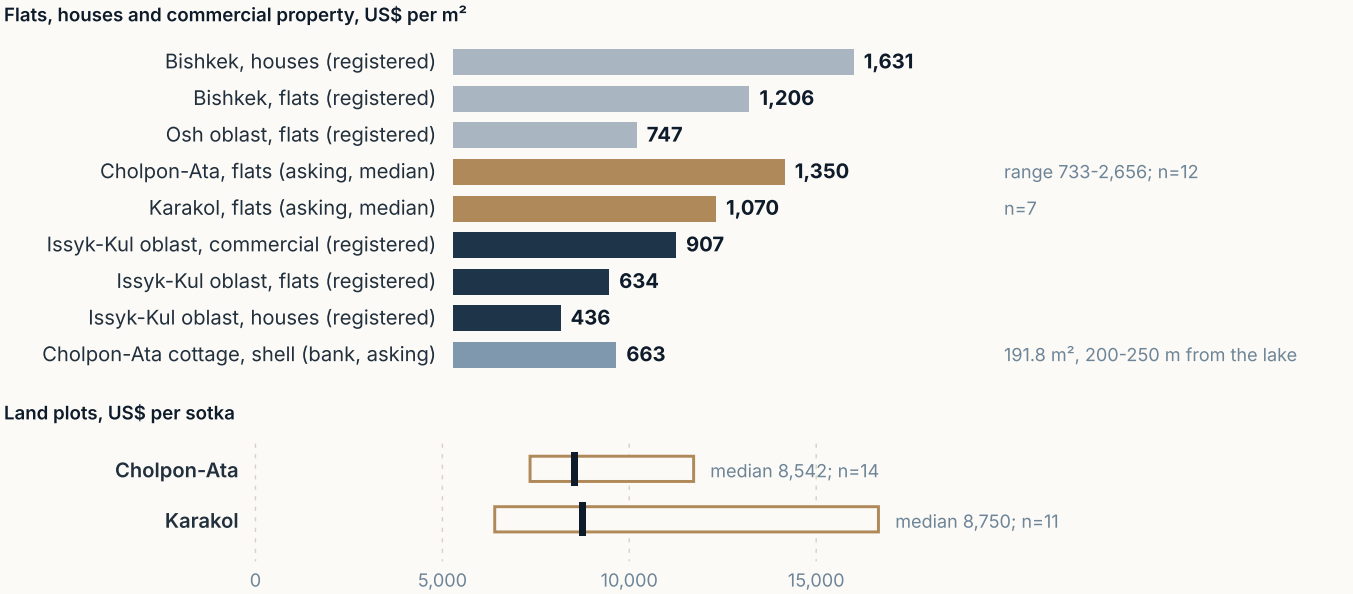
WHAT RESORT PROPERTY COSTS

Flats in Cholpon-Ata are listed at about twice the oblast's registered average, and land at about US$85 a square metre

EXHIBIT 16

Cholpon-Ata flats are listed at a median of about US$1,350 per m², 2.1 times the oblast's registered average; houses register below flats, the reverse of Bishkek

Top: registered average values (early 2025) and median asking prices (2026), US$ per m²; bottom: asking price of land, US$ per sotka (100 m²), interquartile range (box) and median (bar)



Source: State Agency for Land Resources, Cadastre, Geodesy and Cartography via Economist.kg (2025); Heirstone samples of lalafo.kg listings (first page of each category, accessed 2026; rental-type and erroneous prices excluded); Bakai Bank asset listing (asking price). Asking prices are not transactions. KGS at 87.45 per US$ (2026); the rate at the time of the 2025 index was not checked. **Heirstone analysis.**

Registered values put Issyk-Kul flats at KGS 55,400 per m² in early 2025, 53% of Bishkek's, and houses at KGS 38,100, below flats. In Bishkek houses register above flats. On the lake, flats are valued above village houses per square metre, which supports branded and serviced formats such as Ak Keme's flats sold with access to the hotel.

The asking prices sit well above the register: a median of about US$1,350 per m² for flats in Cholpon-Ata and US$1,070 in Karakol, from small samples. Whether that is a premium for new resort flats or a gap between asking and selling prices can only be settled from cadastre transaction data, which lenders should request before they size loans.

Land is listed at a median of US$8,542 a sotka in Cholpon-Ata and US$8,750 in Karakol, about US$85-88 per m². At the top of the mountain market, the most expensive of 49 state plots offered at Jyrgalan was priced at KGS 337m, about US$3.85m, according to Economist.kg.

2.1x

Cholpon-Ata asking price per m² for flats against the oblast's registered average (Heirstone analysis)

53%

Issyk-Kul registered flat values as a share of Bishkek's, early 2025 (Heirstone analysis)

CHAPTER 5

05

Chatkal, Tashkent's next valley

Kyrgyzstan's second mountain cluster lies in the west, in Chatkal District of Jalal-Abad region, across the ridge from Tashkent's ski and lake resorts. The tourism bodies of the two countries signed a cooperation agreement on a resort there in 2024 and are now preparing a cross-border cluster.

A memorandum of understanding on the Kyrgyz Republic–Uzbekistan Cross-Border Sustainable Tourism Cluster Development was on the signing agenda of the 2025 CAREC Ministerial Conference in Bishkek, according to the CAREC Program, and an ADB presentation of 2026 reports it signed; its text is not public. ADB is funding a US$250,000 technical-assistance grant, approved in 2025 under the CAREC Climate and Sustainability Project Preparatory Fund, to prepare a Tourism Strategic Action Plan for Chatkal District. A Spanish–Kyrgyz consultancy joint venture began work in 2026, and ADB's timetable puts a pipeline of priority investments and the final plan in 2027.

On the Uzbek side the cluster links to Amirsoy, an all-season resort 65 km from Tashkent, the Chimgan resort, where a US$269m all-season project is under construction according to Spot.uz, and the Charvak reservoir, a free tourist zone since 2017. On the Kyrgyz side are the planned Chatkal Resort, the Besh-Aral and Sary-Chelek reserves and the Western Tien-Shan World Heritage site, inscribed in 2016 across Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan and Uzbekistan.

The counterparts are new. Kyrgyzstan's State Agency for Tourism Development under the Cabinet of Ministers, created by Presidential Decree No. 133 of 2026, replaced the Tourism Department of the Ministry of Economy and Commerce and is the executing agency for the ADB plan. The Tourism Committee of the Republic of Uzbekistan became a republican executive body in 2025 and is the supporting agency.

US$250k

ADB technical-assistance grant for the Chatkal action plan, due 2027

6.3m

residents of Tashkent city and region at the start of 2026



THE CLUSTER ON THE MAP

The Uzbek resorts lie 65-80 km from Tashkent; Chatkal lies behind a pass of about 2,800 m

EXHIBIT 17

Chatkal lies between Tashkent's mountain resorts and the Western Tien-Shan reserves, about 150 km from Tashkent on the route given by the project presentation

Top: the region from Tashkent to Issyk-Kul; bottom: the Chatkal area, with World Heritage components, resorts, towns and the road over the Chapchyma pass



150 km

from the Chatkal Resort site to Tashkent: 60 km to the border and 90 km on, according to the project presentation

80 km

of the Ala-Buka–Chatkal road asphalted by early 2025, with 20 km of the works left, according to 24.kg

Source: UNESCO World Heritage Centre, Western Tien-Shan component table; GeoNames gazetteer (towns, resorts and the Chapchyma pass, its elevation from the SRTM model); Amirsoy; Anhor.uz (2014); Chatkal Resort presentation (carecprogram.org); 24.kg (2026); Natural Earth. The Chatkal Resort site and Amirsoy are not mapped: no coordinates are published. Boundaries are indicative.

The Chatkal Resort presentation describes a 2,000 ha site between 1,485 m and 2,365 m, crossed by a planned international road. Work on the Ala-Buka–Chatkal road resumed in spring 2026 once the pass reopened, according to 24.kg; a Talas–Chatkal–Tashkent road was at roadmap stage in 2024.

Travel terms have eased. Citizens of both countries have crossed on identity cards since 2023, and agreements signed in 2026 raised the number of crossing points from 15 to 30 and extended stays without registration from 5 to 15 days. Which crossing would serve Chatkal is not published.

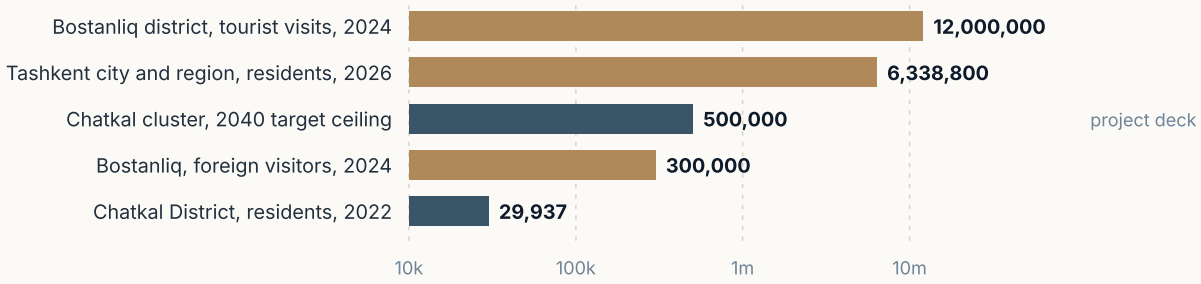
DEMAND AND THE RECORD

The demand is on the Uzbek side of the ridge, and the institutions on both sides are new

EXHIBIT 18

Bostanliq district beside Tashkent drew more than 12 million tourist visits in 2024; the Chatkal Resort project targets fewer than 500,000 tourists in 2040, about 4% of that

Visits, residents and targets on both sides of the Chatkal ridge, log scale



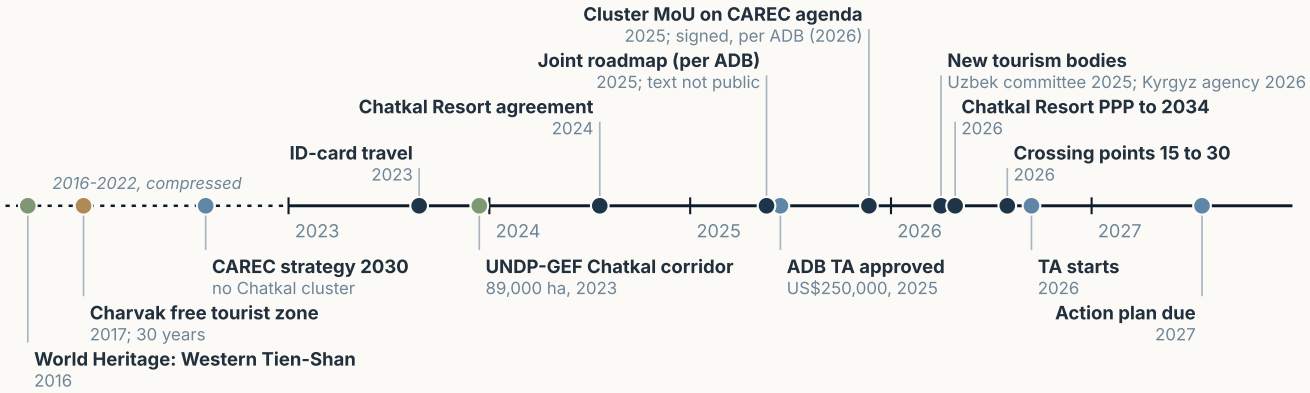
Source: Spot.uz citing the Tashkent region khokimiyat (2025); Statistics Agency of Uzbekistan (2026); Chatkal Resort presentation (carecprogram.org, undated); NSC, 2022 census (2023). Ratio: **Heirstone analysis.**

EXHIBIT 19

The cluster moved from bilateral agreements to a funded action plan in 2024-2026, while both lead agencies were reorganised

Dated instruments, plans and protected-area milestones relevant to a Kyrgyz–Uzbek cluster in Chatkal, 2016-2027

GOVERNMENTS: AGREEMENTS AND INSTITUTIONS



LENDERS, PLANS AND PROTECTED AREAS

Source: CAREC Program (agenda and presentation, 2025); ADB, CAREC Tourism Working Group presentation (2026); Spot.uz (2023; 2026); Economist.kg (2024); 24.kg (2026); kyrgyzstan-tourism.com (2026); President of Uzbekistan (2017; 2025); UNESCO; UNDP Kyrgyzstan (2024). The MoU text and the 2025 roadmap are not public.

Neither country's latest nationally determined contribution (NDC 3.0) mentions tourism. Uzbekistan's plans protected areas on 14.5% of its territory in 2025 and 17% by 2030; Kyrgyzstan's lists mountain ecosystems among those particularly vulnerable. A cluster built around buffer zones, visitor fees and permits can be designed to serve both commitments.

The conservation core shapes the product. IUCN found in 2016 that only Sary-Chelek allowed limited visits among the Kyrgyz components, and UNESCO's biosphere reserve page lists unorganised tourism among the pressures there; volume belongs on the resort site, with the reserves visited by permit.

17%

of Uzbekistan's territory to be protected by 2030 under its NDC 3.0

13,000

places in 59 tourism facilities opened in Bostanliq in 2020-2024

CHAPTER 6

06

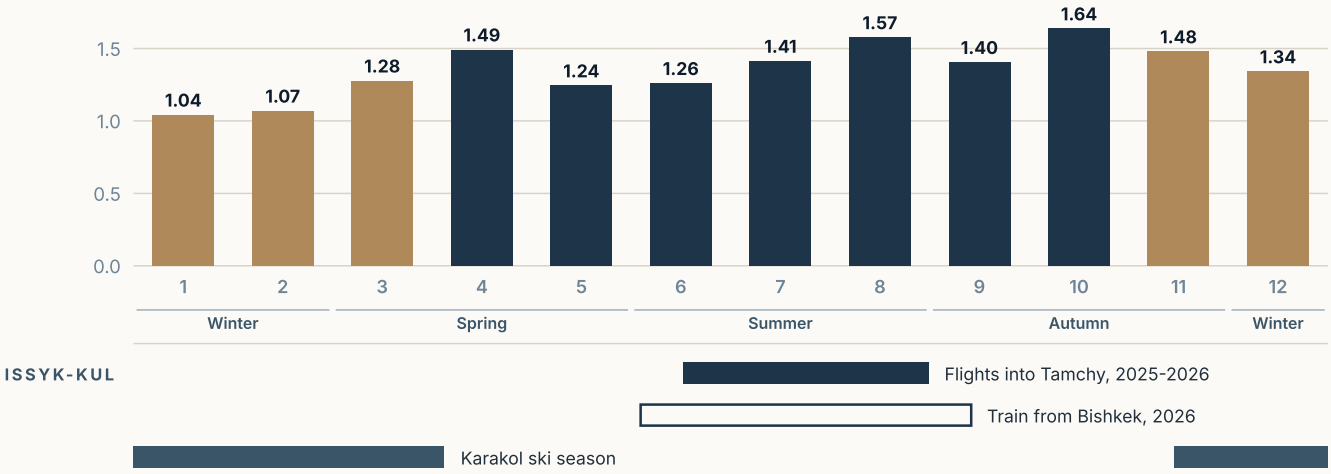
What the Gulf and Egypt bring

Gulf development funds already finance the road around the lake, and guests from Arab countries spend ten summer nights in Salzburg for every winter night. Egypt's Red Sea resorts run a long European season from autumn to spring and stay busy in summer, and its North Coast is adding universities and events to a summer coast. Both are directly relevant to a lake that is busy for ten weeks.

EXHIBIT 20

Air traffic between the EU and Egypt peaked in autumn 2025 and carried 38% of its volume in the five winter months; Issyk-Kul's scheduled access ran only in summer

Air passengers between the EU and Egypt by month (1 to 12), 2025, million (months 11 to 3 in gold), with the periods in which Issyk-Kul's scheduled flights and train ran and its ski season



Source: Eurostat, avia_paexcc, EU27 passengers by partner country (extracted 2026), as compiled for Heirstone's seasonal coasts research; airline and railway announcements as in Exhibit 3. **Heirstone analysis.** The EU–Egypt series covers all Egyptian airports, including Cairo.

Egypt's Red Sea runs two seasons. EU–Egypt air traffic swung 1.57 times between its busiest and quietest months in 2025, with the peak in autumn. El Gouna's 18 hotels (2,676 rooms) averaged 71% occupancy of available rooms in FY2024, according to Orascom Development, above Lake Annecy hotels' 68% in 2022. Hurghada airport handled about 10.5 million passengers in fiscal 2024/25, on official figures; operators expect winter 2026/27 arrivals to rise about 20%, according to Enterprise.

The North Coast offers the other lesson. Egypt's stated aim is a coast that works all year, and New Alamein has an operating university with two more in development, an aerospace show at the end of the beach season and 300,000 tourists expected in 2026, according to Enterprise and Ahram Online. Asman, planned for 500,000-700,000 people, could give the western end of Issyk-Kul a resident base of that kind as its water supply allows.

1.57

EU–Egypt air traffic, busiest month against quietest, 2025 (Heirstone analysis)

71%

occupancy of available rooms at El Gouna's 18 hotels, FY2024

ENTRY POINTS

Gulf development funds are already on the lake's roads; Gulf hotel and residential equity is not yet

EXHIBIT 21

Gulf citizens may stay 180 days a year without a visa and Gulf funds lend to the ring road, but the hotel pipeline is Turkish, Azerbaijani, Russian and Kyrgyz

Entry terms, capital and demand evidence for Gulf states and Egypt on Issyk-Kul, with the countries whose capital is present today

COUNTRY OR LENDER	ENTRY TO KYRGYZSTAN	CAPITAL ON OR AROUND THE LAKE	DEMAND EVIDENCE
United Arab Emirates	180 days in any 360, visa-free	19.9% of tourism FDI in 2024 and 8.2% in 2025; Abu Dhabi Fund named in 2019-2020 reports on the ring-road loan	UAE visitors spend about EUR 531 a day in Austria; direct UAE–Issyk-Kul flights in development (kyrgyzstan-tourism.com, 2026)
Saudi Arabia	180 days in any 360	Saudi Fund for Development lends to the Korumdu–Balbay ring road	Saudi visitors spend about EUR 491 a day in Austria
Kuwait, Qatar, Oman, Bahrain	180 days in any 360	Kuwait Fund lends to the ring road	Guests from Arab countries made up 25.7% of summer nights around Zell am See and Kaprun in 2025
Arab Coordination Group (with OPEC Fund and IsDB)	not applicable	US$128m for 80.5 km of four-lane road with a cycle lane on the north-east shore	n/a
Egypt	not reviewed	None recorded on the lake in the sources reviewed	European traffic peaks in autumn and spring, the reverse of Issyk-Kul; El Gouna hotels 71% occupied, FY2024
Present today: Turkey, Azerbaijan, Russia, Uzbekistan	EAEU 90 in 180; Uzbekistan 60 in 180	RAMS Global (Marriott); Baku Resort & Spa and a Kyrgyz-Azerbaijani fund to be raised to US$200m; Russian-Kyrgyz fund (Azimut); four complexes leased to Uzbek investors	Marriott expects Kyrgyz and Kazakh guests first

Source: VisasNews (2026); NSC (2025; 2026); 24.kg (2019; 2020); Ministry of Transport procurement notice (2021); Salzburg24 citing Österreich Werbung (2026); Kyrgyzstan-tourism.com (2026); Kaktus.media and Economist.kg (2025-2026); Times of Central Asia (2026); Spot.uz (2026); Eurostat avia_paexcc (2026); Orascom Development Holding, Annual Report FY2024.

1 Sell the Gulf a long summer

Guests from Arab countries spend ten summer nights in Land Salzburg for every winter night, and Gulf visitors spend about three times as much a day as Austrians. With 180 visa-free days, villas and serviced apartments for long family stays across the summer would lengthen the lake's season without asking Gulf travellers to come in winter.

2 Pair the seasons with the Red Sea

European traffic to Egypt peaks in autumn and spring, when Issyk-Kul is quiet, and Hurghada hotels reported near-full summer occupancy in 2026, according to Egypt Independent. Operators working on both can share sales teams and seasonal staff across two calendars, if the Issyk-Kul hotel has an anchor that keeps it open beyond summer.

3 Put residents on the coast first

New Alamein's universities and end-of-season events are what a resident base on a summer coast looks like. Asman's first town of about 20,000, the size proposed in 2022, could follow the same order: campus, offices and public services before second homes.

4 Combine road money with hotel equity

Gulf and Arab funds have financed the ring road; no Gulf hotel or residential sponsor appears in the pipeline. The 2024 tenure reform and the airport hotel zone offer an entry, with Turkish, Azerbaijani and Russian capital already present.

180 days
visa-free stay in any 360 for citizens of the six Gulf states

EUR 531
daily spend of UAE visitors in Austria, against EUR 179 for Austrians

US$128m
from Gulf and Arab funds for 80.5 km of the lake's ring road

10.5m
passengers at Hurghada airport in fiscal 2024/25

CHAPTER 7

07 A four-season programme

Applied to Kyrgyzstan's four resort areas, the Heirstone Four-Season Test shows where each stands and which gap to close first. The recommendations that follow come from it.

EXHIBIT 22

No Kyrgyz resort area yet meets more than one of the six conditions in full; the north shore partly meets four, and Karakol meets the snow condition

Heirstone Four-Season Test applied to four resort areas, 2026

● met ◑ partly met or under way ○ not met n/v not verified

RESORT AREA	1. WEATHER-FREE DRAW	2. WEEKEND MARKET	3. ALL-YEAR ACCESS	4. SNOW SEASON	5. SHOULDER CALENDAR	6. PIPES AND DATA	IN FULL / PARTLY	MAIN GAP	STRENGTH TO BUILD ON
North shore: Tamchy to Bosteri	◑	◑	○	○	◑	◑	**0 / 4**	Flights and rail that run beyond summer	Two in three holidaymakers; brands and the ADB sewers are here
Karakol and Ala-Too Resort	n/v	○	◑	●	◑	◑	**1 / 3**	A year-round market within reach	200,000 ski visits a winter; 250 km of runs planned
Asman and the western end	○	◑	◑	○	○	○	**0 / 2**	Water for the planned population	Airport, rail terminus and a decreed city
Chatkal (Kyrgyz side)	○	◑	○	◑	○	◑	**0 / 3**	The road and a tourist-grade crossing	Next to 6.3 million people in Tashkent city and region

North shore. Year-round hotels with conference halls and a 2,000 m² aquathermal centre under construction (1, partly); Bishkek 175 km from Balykchy, Almaty 450-480 km by road (2, partly); all routes in summer only (3, not met); no lifts (4); the spring season opening and the World Nomad Games in 2026 (5, partly); sewers 10% built, census at the summer peak only (6, partly).

Karakol and Ala-Too. No thermal or health anchor in our sources (1, not verified); Bishkek 400 km away (2, not met); twice-weekly flights from Bishkek since late 2024 (3, partly); 20 km of runs and 200,000 visits (4, met); JARYK FEST from 2025 (5, partly); Ala-Too water intake 95% (6, partly).

Asman. No anchor beyond the plan (1); a city decreed for residents, and Balykchy's 51,000 people (2, partly); the 3,800 m runway and a terminal under construction (3, partly); no snow or events (4, 5); water for about 200,000, according to the directorate in 2022, against a design of up to 700,000 (6, not met).

Chatkal. No weather-free anchor (1); Tashkent 150 km away across the border (2, partly); the road at roadmap stage and a seasonal pass (3, not met); over 30 km of runs planned by 2028 (4, partly); no calendar (5); ADB action plan with demand and accommodation analysis due 2027 (6, partly).

Source: Heirstone assessment on the evidence in Exhibits 1 to 21 and the sources cited there. Conditions as defined in chapter 2. n/v: not verified in public sources.

THE ORDER OF WORK THE TEST POINTS TO

1 **Count and connect** monthly data; sewers before new beds

2 **Keep access open** flights from late spring to autumn; rail all year

3 **Anchor the low months** spa, health, meetings and events

4 **Add the snow peak** Karakol, Ala-Too Resort and Chatkal

Data and sewers come first because every later step depends on them. A lender cannot size a winter hotel without monthly nights, and the 2022 decree already makes treatment a condition of operating a resort.

Access comes next because the lake's air and rail links run only in summer. Anchors and events follow, as Hévíz, Annecy and Garda Trentino show; snow comes last, since in the Alps it adds a peak without filling spring and late autumn.

RECOMMENDATIONS

For the state: count every month and keep the lake's routes open after summer

CENTRAL GOVERNMENT

State Agency for Tourism Development

1. **Count the lake every month.** Replace reliance on the ten-day summer census with a monthly survey of beds open, nights and guests' origin in all accommodation, guesthouses included, and publish it quarterly. The national guesthouse total today is the lake's high-summer count.
2. **Keep the air bridge open from late spring to autumn.** Underwrite shoulder-month rotations on the routes airlines already fly in summer, Almaty, Astana and Tashkent to Tamchy, and market the new terminal for the months either side of summer.
3. **Build an events calendar for the shoulder months and measure it.** Add recurring events in late spring and early autumn to the season opening and the World Nomad Games venues, keep JARYK FEST as the winter opener, and report the nights each event adds, as Garda Trentino does.
4. **Take Chatkal forward with the Tourism Committee of the Republic of Uzbekistan.** Use the 2026-2027 joint action plan, and the group fast track and checkpoint status discussed in 2026, to identify the crossing for Chatkal, and offer a joint ski pass with Amirsoy and Chimgan once the road opens.

REGION AND TOWNS

Issyk-Kul regional administration

1. **Connect before licensing.** Make connection to the ADB-funded network a condition of new beds in Cholpon-Ata and Bosteri, apply the 2022 decree to guesthouses, and use the Cholpon-Ata package, about US$4,570 per m^3 of daily capacity all-in, as a first reference for Tamchy and Karakol.
2. **Run the train all year and link it to the resorts.** Turn the summer Bishkek–Balykchy service into a year-round weekend train with a shuttle along the north shore, the cheapest access to the lake at KGS 150-180.
3. **Plan the 100-500 m band.** Publish a shoreline plan that places piers, promenades and steam baths allowed since 2025 next to winterised hotels in the 100-500 m band, and keeps beaches public as the 2022 decree requires.
4. **Phase Asman with its water supply.** The directorate put the water supply at about 200,000 people in 2022, and the head of the Cabinet proposed a first town of about 20,000; a campus, offices or public bodies first would follow New Alamein's order.

WHAT TO WATCH

INDICATOR	LATEST	NEXT MARKER	SOURCE
Nights on Issyk-Kul by month	not published; ten-day census at the summer peak	monthly survey, all accommodation	NSC
Tamchy passengers outside summer	40,300 in all of 2024; no monthly data	routes in late spring and autumn	Airports of Kyrgyzstan
Issyk-Kul share of hotel and restaurant revenue	3.8% (KGS 2,786m, 2025)	a rising share as formal beds grow	NSC open data
Foreign guests in the lake's guesthouse survey	about 27,000 of 558,000 (2025)	growth with Kazakh and Gulf routes	NSC
Branded hotels open on the north shore	Baku Resort & Spa, 120+ rooms (2026)	Azimut; Mövenpick; Marriott in 2028	operators; press
Cholpon-Ata sewer works	10% (Q3 2025)	plant in service; connection rate	ADB 55250-001
Ala-Too Resort first ski zone	due by end-2026	skier visits, first season	Ministry of Construction
Chatkal action plan	started 2026	investment pipeline and final plan, 2027	ADB; State Agency

RECOMMENDATIONS

For developers, operators and lenders: anchor the beds and fund the pipes

BUILDING

Developers

1 **Build an anchor into every year-round project.** Pair rooms with a spa, thermal pool or meeting space, as Elizaveta Resort's 2,000 m^2 aquathermal centre and Karven Four Seasons' 350-seat hall do, on the Tamchy–Bosteri spine.

2 **Design to the land norm and price from transactions.** At 0.01 ha a guest, low-density villas and hotels fit better than flats; size branded-residence pricing on cadastre sales, since listings run at twice the registered average.

3 **Put the winter product in the 100-500 m band.** Place heated pools, spas and meeting rooms in buildings set back from the water, with the piers and promenades now allowed closer to the shore.

RUNNING

Operators

1 **Plan for 25-40% annual bed use.** Tirol used 38% of its bed-nights in 2025 and Carinthia's lakes 23%; sell two-to-three-night packages to Bishkek, Almaty and Tashkent.

2 **Run two calendars.** Pair the lake's summer with Red Sea properties, where European traffic peaks in autumn and again in spring, and give Gulf families villas and long-stay rates for the summer months.

3 **Sell the shoulder months to the markets that already come.** Kazakh citizens made 25% of foreign crossings in 2025, and Marriott's partner expects Kazakhstan to be its second market after Kyrgyz guests.

FINANCING

Investors and development finance institutions

1 **Fund the pipes first.** Replicate the Cholpon-Ata package in Bosteri, Tamchy and Karakol; it is the condition for every hotel loan on the shore.

2 **Base ski finance on a demand study.** Commission demand work for Ala-Too Resort, whose capacity has been reported at 850,000 and at 2 million a year, against 200,000 visits at Karakol and ADB's 480,000 for Cholpon-Ata in 2038.

3 **Bring Gulf equity to the airport hotel zone.** Gulf funds lend to the ring road, but no Gulf hotel sponsor appears in the pipeline; the building-and-lease tenure, PPPs of up to 49 years and Tamchy's nine 10 ha plots offer an entry.

4 **Follow the Chatkal plan.** Prepare to finance the road, crossing and visitor facilities in the priority investment pipeline due in 2027, framed against Uzbekistan's 17% protected-area target and the mountain ecosystems Kyrgyzstan's NDC lists as vulnerable.

The test and the benchmark can be updated as soon as Kyrgyzstan publishes nights by month; the first year of such data would show how far the lake sits from Balaton's beach shore and from its thermal one.

Heirstone advises governments, developers, investors and lenders on destination strategy, resort and hotel demand, highest and best use, feasibility and phasing.

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NOTES, SOURCES AND DEFINITIONS

Notes

Definitions

Holidaymakers: NSC's count of people who rested in the organised sector (collective accommodation) and the unorganised sector (guesthouses and private homes); the unorganised count for Issyk-Kul covers its resort zone. **Heirstone Season Ratio:** nights in the busiest month divided by nights in the quietest month of a calendar year. **Bed-place utilisation:** nights divided by bed-places times days. **Months** are numbered 1 to 12 from the start of the calendar year; **high summer** means months 7 and 8, and seasons are those of the northern hemisphere. **Summer and winter** in Austria: the statistical half-years beginning in months 5 and 11. **Asking prices** are listings, not transactions.

Method

The Heirstone Season Benchmark uses Eurostat monthly nights for 13 NUTS 2 regions and KSH monthly nights for three Balaton counties, with Eurostat airport data and season figures from Austria, Kazakhstan, Georgia, France, Slovenia and Egypt. NUTS 2 regions are wider than the lakes named. The Heirstone Four-Season Test scores resort areas only on evidence in the public record. US$ conversions use NBKR rates at publication in 2026: KGS 87.45 per US$ and US$1.1193 per EUR; tenge at KZT 451.31 and sum at UZS 11,899.09. Where sources conflict we give the range or the more conservative figure and attribute each. Map positions are published coordinates except where marked approximate.

Use of this report

This report is published for general information. It is not investment, legal or valuation advice and should not be relied on as such. It uses only public information, and no government body, developer, operator, investor or lender named in it reviewed it. Images are illustrative.

1 HALF THE HOLIDAYS, ONE SUMMER

National Statistical Committee (NSC): Tourism in Kyrgyzstan 2015-2019 (2020), 2020-2024 (2025), 2021-2025 (2026); NSC open data (holidaymakers; sanatoria; hotel and restaurant services; tourism indicators; air passengers); NSC express releases (2023; Q1 2024). Department of Tourism (border-point counts). National Bank of the Kyrgyz Republic (balance of payments 9M 2025; rates). World Bank WDI. Economist.kg, 24.kg, Kaktus.media, Tengrinews, Trend, Finance.kz, BES.media, Aeroroutes, UzDaily, VisasNews, Xinhua, government e-visa portal, Karakol ski base and Skiresort.com, as cited.

2 HOW LAKES AND MOUNTAINS FILL THE YEAR

Eurostat: tour_occ_nin2m, tour_cap_nuts2, avia_paoa, avia_paexcc (extracted 2026) and Statistics Explained, Seasonality in the tourist accommodation sector. KSH STADAT 27.2.2.1. Land Salzburg season reports 2025. Salzburg24 (2026). Economx (2024). Regione del Veneto (2026); Garda Dolomiti APT (2022; 2025); Bled Tourist Board; Savoie Mont Blanc Tourisme (2023); Les Sources du Lac d'Annecy (2025); Gletscherbahnen Kaprun; Investor.ge; FactCheck.ge; Geostat; 24.kz; Forbes Kazakhstan; Kazinform; St. Andrew Hospital for Rheumatology and Medicinal Spa Hévíz (2026); e-history.kz, QazContent (2026).

3 WHAT IS BEING BUILT

Kaktus.media (2016; 2021-2026); Economist.kg (2023-2026); 24.kg (2024-2025); Times of Central Asia (2024; 2026); WE Project (2026); TÜRKSAM (2023; 2026); National Investment Agency (project cards; preferences; SEZs); OPEC Fund; Ministry of Transport and Communications; ADB 55250-001 and 41548-013; event-legacy research for the 2029 Asian Winter Games; Balykchy Mayor's Office (2019); ILEC World Lake Database; Georgian National Tourism Administration (2024); Skiresort.com; GeoNames.

4 THE HUNDRED-METRE LINE

Law No. 115 of 2004 and Government Resolution No. 547 of 2004 (FAOLEX); Presidential Decree UP No. 370 (2023); Economist.kg (2024-2026); 24.kg (2022); ADB 55250-001; State Agency for Land Resources, Cadastre, Geodesy and Cartography via Economist.kg (2025); lalafo.kg listings; Bakai Bank; UNESCO MAB (Issyk-Kul).

5 CHATKAL, TASHKENT'S NEXT VALLEY

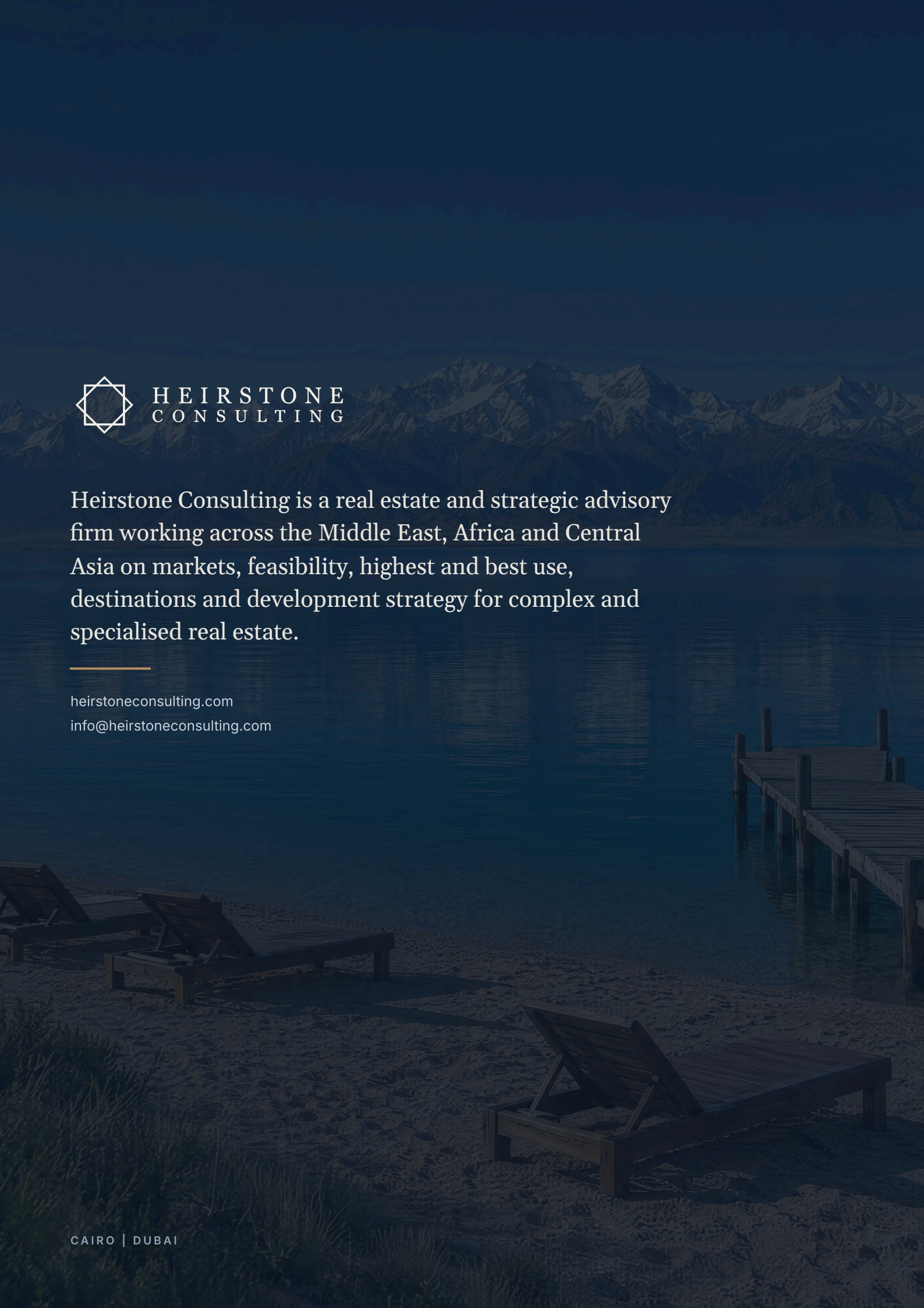
CAREC Program (24th Ministerial Conference agenda and presentation, 2025); ADB (CAREC Tourism Working Group, 2026; CAREC Tourism Strategy 2030); Chatkal Resort presentation; Cabinet of Ministers (Programme 2025-2030); President of Uzbekistan (UP-5273; UP-217; resolution on the Tourism Committee, 2025; press service 2020, 2024); Tourism Committee of the Republic of Uzbekistan; NDC 3.0 of Uzbekistan and of the Kyrgyz Republic; NDC Partnership; UNESCO World Heritage Centre and MAB; IUCN (2016; 2022-2024); UNDP Kyrgyzstan and Uzbekistan; Statistics Agency of Uzbekistan; Spot.uz; Anhor.uz; Podrobno.uz; 24.kg; Akchabar; Kaktus.media; kyrgyzstan-tourism.com; Amirsoy; NSC, 2022 census (2023); GeoNames.

6 WHAT THE GULF AND EGYPT BRING

Eurostat avia_paexcc via Heirstone seasonal coasts research; Orascom Development Holding, Annual Report FY2024; Egypt Independent (2026); Enterprise (2025; 2026); Ahram Online (2026); Asharq Al-Awsat citing the Ministry of Civil Aviation (2025); as for chapters 1 to 3 for Gulf terms and capital.

7 A FOUR-SEASON PROGRAMME

Heirstone assessment based on the sources listed for chapters 1 to 6.



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Heirstone Consulting is a real estate and strategic advisory firm working across the Middle East, Africa and Central Asia on markets, feasibility, highest and best use, destinations and development strategy for complex and specialised real estate.

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